H-B-00555B(GSA-FSS)
January 28, 1971
Interim Revision of
Fed. Spec. H-B-555a
January 28, 1966

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRUSH, SCRUB, VEGETABLE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C., 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification H-B-555a, dated January 28, 1966.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers vegetable scrub brushes with plastic handles and twisted-in-wire curved brush heads of synthetic filaments (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and classes. Brushes covered by this specification shall be of one type and the following classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Class 1. Synthetic handle and nylon filaments.

Class 2. Synthetic handle and polypropylene filaments.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

H-S- 951 - Synthetic Filaments, General Specifications for Brushes.
L-P- 394 - Plastic Molding Material, Propylene Plastics, Injection and Extrusion.
L-P-1183 - Plastic Molding Material, Acrylonitrile-Butadiene-Styrene (ABS) Rigid.
O-S- 602 - Sodium Hypochlorite Solution.
PPP-B- 566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B- 636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B- 665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B- 676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

21CFR 121 - Food Additives.

(Copies of the regulations cited above may be obtained upon written request to the Mailing and Distribution Unit, CA238, Food and Drug Administration, HEW, 200 C Street, S.W., Washington, D. C. 20402.

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are on sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent, 1616 P Street, N.W., DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Tariff Publishing Officer, Room 202 Union Station, 516 W. Jackson Blvd., Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. When specified (see 6.2), before production is begun, three sample brushes of each class shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval in accordance with 4.2. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the supplier of the responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of the specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production item.

3.2 Materials. In addition to the requirements for materials specified herein, brush materials shall comply with the applicable requirements of 21 CFR 121 - Food Additives (see 4.3.1). Materials shall also be free from ingredients that impart odor to foods.

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3.2.1 Filaments.

3.2.1.1 Class 1, nylon filaments. Class 1 filaments shall comply with the requirements for class N, type III crimped filaments of H-S-951. The average diameter of crimped filaments shall be 0.012 ± 0.001 inch (see 4.4.3). the average crimp frequency No. 13 (see 4.4.4), and the average wave amplitude HD (deep) 0.010 inch (see 4.4.4). The filaments shall be natural color (undyed).

3.2.1.2 Class 2, polypropylene filaments. Class 2 filaments shall comply with the requirements for class P, type III crimped, of H-S-951. The average diameter of crimped filaments shall be 0.012 ± 0.001 inch (see 4.4.3), the average crimp frequency No. 10 (see 4.4.4), and the average wave amplitude 0.022 inch (see 4.4.4). The filaments shall be natural color (undyed).

3.2.2 Plastics for brush handles. At the option of the manufacturer, handles shall be molded polypropylene or molded acrylonitrile-butadiene-styrene that is resistant to boiling water, mild chemicals and cleaning solutions, as specified below:

(a) Polypropylene in conformance with type I of L-P-394.
(b) Acrylonitrile-butadiene-styrene in conformance with type IV of L-P-1183.

3.2.2.1 Auxiliary adaptors. Auxiliary adaptors shall be molded plastic, identical or compatible with the material for the handle.

3.2.3 Wire. Twisting wire shall be corrosion resisting wire not less than 0.0885 inch in diameter (U. S. Steel gage No. 13).

3.2.4 Bonding agent. The bonding agent for securing the twisted ends of the brush head within the plastic handle, or an auxiliary adaptor and collar to the handle shall be (1) the plastic material of the handle or adaptor fused to the wire end by heat induction, (2) a suitable solvent-type adhesive, or (3) an adhesive such as an epoxy resin, provided the resulting bond between joined parts meets the requirements of this specification (see 3.9 and 3.10).

3.3 Design. Brushes shall have a curved brush head as illustrated in figure 1. The design of the handle shall be the manufacturer's option provided the design permits the handle to be held securely in the hand without discomfort, and the handle otherwise meets the basic requirements of this specification.

3.4 Construction. Brushes shall be constructed as follows and shall conform with the physical requirements in table I.

3.4.1 Brush part. Brush parts shall consist of the filaments specified in 3.2.1.1 or 3.2.1.2, held at their centers in the twists of two wires in such a manner that they project perpendicular to and flare around the circumference of the twisted wires. The filaments shall be distributed so that they form a sufficiently stiff and dense working surface over the entire curved brush part to adequately clean vegetables without direct exposure of the twisted wires to the surface to be cleaned (see table II). The wire shall be evenly and tightly twisted so that the filaments are held securely and cannot be dislodged when tested as specified in 4.4.5. All wire surfaces shall be rounded and smooth. Filaments shall be evenly trimmed. When handles and brush parts are joined by means of an adhesive, prior to assembly, the ends of the twisted wires to be inserted within the hole in the handle shall be covered with the adhesive, held together, and allowed to dry in this position.

TABLE I. Physical requirements of brushes

Characteristics		Requirement
Length of brush, overall, minimum	inches	8-1/2
Brush part:		
Width, overall, minimum	inches	3-1/2
Length, overall, minimum	do.	3-1/2
Diameter of cylindrical brush part, overall, minimum	do.	1-1/2
Length of filaments, minimum	do.	1-3/16
Weight of filaments per brush, minimum:		
Nylon	oz.	0.447
Polypropylene	oz.	0.375
Handle:		
Length, minimum	inches	3-1/2
Diameter or width, as applicable:		
Widest dimension, overall	inch	7/8 ± 1/8
Narrowest dimension	do.	3/4 ± 1/8
Thickness or depth, overall	do.	1/2 ± 1/4 - 1/8

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3.4.2 Handle. Handles shall be molded plastic in accordance with 3.2.2, smoothly finished and free from sharp edges and other imperfections that could be injurious or cause discomfort to the user. One end of the handle shall have a center hole, an integral adaptor, or an auxiliary adaptor as specified in 3.2.2.1, to receive the twisted wire ends of the brush part and the bonding agent specified in 3.2.4. Auxiliary adaptors shall be bonded to the handle by a suitable bonding agent as specified in 3.2.4. The hole in the handle or adaptor shall coincide with the axis of the handle and shall be of sufficient size to receive at least 3/4 inch of the twisted wire ends of the brush part described in 3.4.1 plus sufficient bonding agent to securely join the wires and handle so that they will not loosen or separate when tested as described in 4.4.6 and 4.4.7.

3.4.3 Provision for hanging brushes. Brushes shall be provided with a centrally located hole near the end of the handle for convenience in hanging them when not in use. The hole shall go through the handle in a direction perpendicular to the axis of the handle. The size of the hole and the distance from the end of the handle shall be the manufacturer's option provided the serviceability, durability, or appearance of the brushes is not adversely affected.

3.5 Color of handles. Unless otherwise specified, handles shall be natural color, i.e., no artificial coloring shall be added to the plastic compound.

3.6 Total weight of filaments in each brush. The total weight of filaments in each brush shall be as specified in table I when determined as described in 4.4.1.

3.7 Specific gravity and melting point of filaments. The specific gravity and melting point of class 1 nylon and class 2 polypropylene filaments shall be as specified in H-S-951 when determined as specified in 4.4.2 herein.

3.8 Tuft retention. When subjected to a pulling force of 8 ± 0.5 pounds as specified in 4.4.5, no tuft shall be dislodged from the twisted wires.

3.9 Resistance of brushes to sodium hypochlorite.

3.9.1 After immersion. After immersion in sodium hypochlorite solution containing 1.0 percent by weight available chlorine for not less than 24 hours and not more than 25 hours at a temperature maintained at 23° ± 2°C. (73.5° ± 3.6°F.) by the method described in 4.4.6, brushes shall meet the following requirements:

(1) The bonding agent shall show no signs of softening or deteriorating in any way that will permit loosening or separation of bonded parts.
(2) Filaments shall show no evidence of artificial color.

3.9.2 After drying. After drying for at least 24 hours as specified in 4.4.6, brushes shall meet the following requirements:

(1) Filaments shall show no evidence of damage or change in stiffness that will affect the serviceability of the brush.
(2) Wire shall be free from rust and other damage.
(3) The bonding agent shall not become brittle or deteriorate in any way that will permit loosening or separation of bonded parts or loosening of wire twists and shedding of filaments before or after testing as described in 4.4.8, 4.4.9, and 4.4.10.
(4) Handles shall not crack, split, break, chip, craze, deform, or show other evidence of deterioration that would affect their performance in service, before or after testing as specified in 4.4.8. 4.4.9, and 4.4.10.

3.10 Resistance to boiling water.

3.10.1 After immersion. After immersion in water maintained at a temperature not less than 100°C. (212° F.) for not less than 20 minutes and not more than 25 minutes as described in 4.4.7, brushes shall meet requirements (1) and (2) of 3.9.1.

3.10.2 After drying. After drying for not less than 24 hours and not less than 25 hours as described in 4.4.7, brushes shall meet requirements (1) through (4) of 3.9.2. After testing as described in 4.4.8, 4.4.9, and 4.4.10, brushes shall meet requirements (3) and (4) of 3.9.2.

3.11 Identification marking. Brushes shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark and the Federal stock number. In addition, brushes shall be marked or tagged with the name of the plastic material of which the handle is composed.

3.12 Workmanship. Brushes shall be free from defects which may affect their serviceability, durability, or appearance. Occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable quality level (AQL).

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When a preproduction sample is required, it shall be examined for defects in table II and for specified dimensions. The preproduction sample shall be tested in accordance with 4.4, as applicable to each class.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Inspection of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with the specified requirements or referenced subsidiary documents or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.3.2 End item examination and testing.

4.3.2.1 Lot. For the purpose of examination and testing of the end item, a lot shall consist of all brushes of one class offered for delivery at one time.

4.3.2.2 Examination other than dimensional. Brushes shall be examined for defects in table II. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL) 4.0 defects per 100 units. The unit for examination shall be one brush. If the number of defects in the sample for examination exceeds the specified acceptance number in MIL-STD-105, the entire lot of brushes shall be considered to be defective.

TABLE II. Classification of defects other than dimensional

Examination	Defects
Materials:	
Plastic handles	Not natural color. Not smoothly finished. Presence of sharp edges and other imperfections that could be injurious to user. Distorted, cracked, or pitted. Odor that could be imparted to foods.
Synthetic filaments	Not as specified.
Wire	Not smooth and rounded.
Construction and design:	
Handles	No provision for hanging. Hole inconveniently placed. Not suitable for hanging. Not designed as specified.
Brush part	Not clean; evidence of foreign matter. Working surface ineffective (see note 1).
Bonding agent	Adhesive brittle - can be removed and reduced to powder by crushing with knife blade. Does not fill hole in handle or adaptor, as applicable. Joined parts loose and easily moved or separated by hand.

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TABLE II. Classification of defects other than dimensional (Con.)

Examination	Defects
Filaments	Not securely held in wire twists. Can be easily removed by hand. Not evenly distributed over brush part. Not evenly trimmed. Not perpendicular to and flared around the circumference of twisted wires.
Identification marking (see 3.12)	Illegible, incomplete.

1. When brush part is passed back and forth over the palm of the hand in a manner simulating use in service, filaments shall not bend back and expose wire to hand.

4.3.2.3 Dimensional examination. Brushes shall be examined for conformance with the applicable dimensional requirements in table I. The inspection level shall be S-3, and the acceptable quality level (AQL) 6.5 percent defective. The unit for examination shall be one brush. If any brush in the sample for test fails to meet any of the applicable requirements in tables I for which examination is made, the brush shall be considered defective. If the number of defective brushes in the sample for examination exceeds the acceptance number in MIL-STD-105, the entire lot of brushes shall be considered defective.

4.3.2.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for delivery at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units. Defects shall be scored as specified in table III.

TABLE III. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examination	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior containers)	Missing, incorrect, illegible, or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Component missing, damaged or otherwise defective.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of case liners (when applicable), container flaps, loose strapping or tape banding; bulging or distortion of containers.

4.3.2.5 Testing. Brushes shall be tested for conformance with the applicable requirements of this specification by the method specified in 4.4. The test unit shall be three brushes. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) 4.0. If any brush in the sample for test fails to meet any requirements for which test is made, the test unit shall be considered defective. If the number of defective test units in the sample for test exceeds the specified acceptance number in MIL-STD-105, the entire lot of brushes shall be considered defective.

4.4 Test methods. Unless otherwise specified herein, tests shall be conducted at room temperature, 27° ± 5°C. (80° ± 9°F.).

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4.4.1 Total weight of synthetic filaments per brush. The weight of the nylon filaments from one class 1 brush or the weight of the polypropylene filaments from one class 2 brush shall be determined as follows: Remove the filaments from one brush, weigh them, record the results, and check for conformance with the applicable requirement in table I. Reserve the filaments for use in the tests in 4.4.2, 4.4.3, and 4.4.4.

4.4.2 Melting point and specific gravity of filaments. The melting point and specific gravity of the nylon filaments or the polypropylene filaments from 4.4.1 shall be determined in accordance with the applicable method in H-S-951 and the results checked for conformance with the applicable requirements in H-S-951.

4.4.3 Diameter of crimped filaments. The diameter of crimped nylon filaments or crimped polypropylene filaments from 4.4.1, shall be determined by the applicable method in H-S-951 and the results checked for conformance with the requirement in 3.2.1.1 or 3.2.1.2, as applicable.

4.4.4 Wave amplitude and crimp frequency of filaments. The wave amplitude and crimp frequency of the nylon or polypropylene filaments from 4.4.1 shall be determined by the applicable method in H-S-951 and the results checked for conformance with 3.2.1.1 or 3.2.1.2, as applicable.

4.4.5 Tuft retention. For the purpose of testing twisted-in-wire brushes, a specimen shall be a tuft, that is, all of the fibers or filaments held in one twist of two wire strands. Five specimens from different locations on the brush head shall be tested. At least two of the five tuft specimens shall be located in the leading end of the brush head. The test shall be as follows: Secure the handle in a suitable stationary clamping device, and one end of the filaments in the specimen for test in another clamp so that they are evenly distributed and so as to prevent distortion and cutting. Care shall be taken to assure that both ends of the same filament are not held in the clamping device. By means of a spring scale or weight, apply the required force (see 3.8) in a direction perpendicular to the twisted wire strands to determine conformance with 3.8.

4.4.6 Resistance to sodium hypochlorite. One brush from each test unit shall be tested for resistance to sodium hypochlorite solution as follows: Completely submerge the brush in a container of the required solution (see 3.9.1) prepared from sodium hypochlorite complying with O-S-602. Allow the brush to remain completely submerged in the solution for the required time (see 3.9.1). Care should be taken that the brush does not come in contact with the bottom or sides of the container. The solution shall be maintained at the required temperature (see 3.9.1) during the test. At the end of the required immersion period, remove the brush from the solution, rinse it thoroughly in water, and examine it for compliance with 3.9.1. Allow the brush to dry for the required period of time (see 3.9.2), examine it for compliance with 3.9.2, and then test it as specified in 4.4.8, 4.4.9, and 4.4.10.

4.4.7 Resistance to boiling water. One brush from each test unit shall be tested as follows: Place the brush in a container of water adjusted to the required temperature for the required time (see 3.10.1), taking care that it is completely immersed and that water circulates freely around it during the immersion period. At the end of the immersion period, remove the brush from the water and examine it for compliance with 3.10.1. Allow the brush to dry for the required time (see 3.10.2), examine it for compliance with 3.10.2, and then test it as specified in 4.4.8, 4.4.9. and 4.4.10.

4.4.8 Pull test. Hold the handle firmly in one hand and the brush part in the other and pull with any force capable of being exerted without mechanical aid to determine conformance with (3) and (4) of 3.9.2.

4.4.9 Turning test. Grasp the handle around the ferrule end with one hand and the brush head with the other hand. Twist the brush head rapidly clockwise and counterclockwise (approximately 10 degrees) ten times in each direction, taking care not to permanently distort the wire. Observe for conformance with (3) and (4) of 3.9.2.

4.4.10 Resistance of brush to impact. Drop the brush five times from the height of 10 feet onto a hard surface such as stone or concrete so that the handle strikes the surface each time. After each drop examine the brush for conformance with (3) and (4) of 3.9.2 .

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. The brushes shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method III.

5.1.2 Level B. Twelve brushes shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. The brushes shall be arranged in an alternating bristle-to-handle order in the box. The box shall be secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.3 Level C. The brushes shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. The brushes shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PP-B-636, V2b Each box shall be closed, waterproof sealed with tape, and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. Gross weight of each box shall not exceed 70 pounds.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty-four packages of brushes, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, type, class, and style optional. Bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be not less than 200 p.s.i. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The brushes shall be packaged to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Brushes covered by this specification are primarily intended for use in cleaning raw vegetables such as potatoes, carrots, cucumbers, squash, celery, and the like that are served at the table without removing the skin.

6.2 Ordering dates. Purchasers should exercise any options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Class of brush required.
(c) Color required if other than natural (see 3.5).
(d) When a preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(e) Applicable levels of packing and packaging.

6.3 Illustration. Figure 1 is furnished for illustration purposes only. To the extent of any inconsistencies between the written specification and the figure, the written specification shall govern.

MILITARY INTEREST:

DOD COORDINATION HAS BEEN WAIVED.

GSA DC 71-8865

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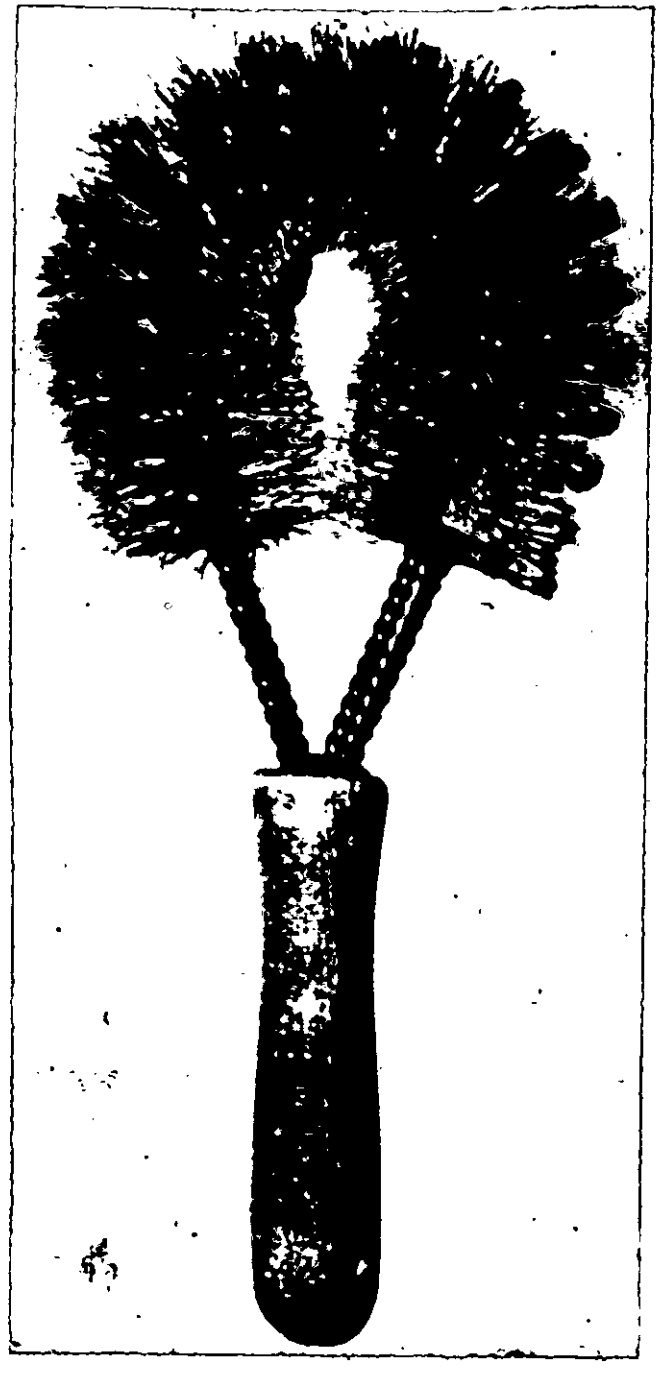


FIGURE 1. General design of vegetable scrub brush.

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GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION - FEDERAL SUPPLY SERVICE

SPECIFICATION COMMENT SHEET

BUDGET BUREAU NO. 29-R0175

INSTRUCTIONS

This form provides a way for users of this specification to inform the originator of problems encountered in its use. It is not to be used to request changes to accommodate proprietary features. All comments will be considered and appreciated, but please do not expect a reply. To comment: detach, complete, and mail to: General Services Administration, FSS (FMSB), Wash., DC 20406.

NOTE: Comments on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any part of the document or serve to amend contractual requirements.

1. SPECIFICATION

H-B-00555B(GSA-FSS) Brush, Scrub, Vegetable

2. CONTRACT NO. *(If any)*	3. QUANTITY ON CONTRACT *(Optional)*	4. DOLLAR VALUE *(Optional)*

5. GENERAL NATURE OF PROBLEM *(e.g., inspection difficulties, manufacturers unable to meet tolerances, containers collapse under normal warehousing conditions, etc.)*

6. SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AFFECTED *(Include paragraph number and lines of wording)*

7. SPECIFIC PROBLEMS *(e.g. tests in 4.2.2 will not assure that the battery will last required time; temperature ranges in table 2 do not conform to commercially available items.)*

8. RECOMMENDATIONS

9. NAME OF MANUFACTURER, ASSOCIATION, GOVT., AGENCY, ETC.	10. ADDRESS *(Number, Street, City, State and Zip Code)*

11. NAME AND TITLE OF SUBMITTER	12. DATE

FORM GSA-FED 69 2200

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